

Benedict Okojie

Lead Software Engineer and Architect

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Professional Summary:

Seasoned Lead Software Engineer, Senior Architect, and Technical Manager with over 15 years of experience in software engineering, architecture, and team leadership. Known for a collaborative and mentoring leadership style, with a passion for guiding teams to deliver scalable, high-performing solutions across a range of industries. Expert in full software development lifecycle management, solution and software architecture, and leading cross-functional teams both onshore and offshore. Skilled at balancing technical leadership with strategic oversight to drive business growth.

Technical Skills:

- **Programming Languages:** Extensive experience in C# (ASP.Net Core, Xamarin, MAUI), Java (SpringBoot, Micronaut), Python (Django), Swift, and JavaScript (Angular 16/17, React).
- **Databases:** Strong expertise in SQL and NoSQL databases including Oracle, MySQL, MSSQL, MongoDB, RavenDB, and DynamoDB.
- **Messaging Systems:** Proficient in RabbitMQ, Kafka, Redis, and ActiveMQ for handling distributed messaging and ensuring reliable communication.
- **Software Architecture & Development:** Experienced in solution design and architecture with a focus on high availability, scalability, and maintainability for mission-critical systems.
- **RESTful APIs:** Expert in designing and implementing RESTful Web APIs to integrate various systems and streamline data communication.
- **Cloud Technologies:** Proficient in cloud technologies and CI/CD best practices, with experience in AWS and Azure cloud platforms and DevOps integration. With tools like Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCI, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Gitlab pipelines.
- **Testing:** Proficient in Test Driven Development, Unit and Integration testing and Test Automation with tools like Postman.
- **Continuous Integration & Deployment:** Skilled in automating development processes and ensuring seamless integration across environments.
- **Technical Writing & QA:** Strong ability to produce clear technical documentation, conduct thorough code reviews, and ensure adherence to quality standards.
- **Algorithm Implementation:** Expertise in developing and optimizing algorithms to solve complex technical challenges.

Leadership Style and Experience:

- **Collaborative Leadership:** Known for fostering a culture of innovation, collaboration, and learning within technical teams. Hands-on leader, focused on empowering team members and providing opportunities for growth.
- **Mentorship & Team Development:** Actively mentoring developers, focusing on skill enhancement and career development. Known for identifying individual strengths and aligning them with team goals.
- **Project Management:** Proven ability to manage complex projects, balancing multiple priorities and ensuring delivery on time and within scope. Experienced in coordinating geographically distributed teams.
- **Solution-Oriented:** Skilled at aligning technical solutions with broader business objectives, ensuring projects deliver tangible value. Strong at identifying risks, setting clear objectives, and guiding teams toward successful outcomes.

Professional Experience:

Senior Software Engineer, 07/2022 - Current

Guestlogix Inc – Toronto, ON

- Led key modernization projects, including migrating core applications from Xamarin to .NET MAUI, focusing on improving performance and scalability.
- Extensive experience in backend development using .NET Core v8 and previous versions, ensuring robust, scalable platforms.
- Led the design and implementation of RESTful Web APIs for seamless integration across systems.
- Working with Kafka to enhance system communication and ensure real-time data consistency.
- Developed scalable applications using C# (ASP.Net Core, Xamarin, MAUI), Python (Vanilla and Django), and SwiftUI, ensuring timely project delivery through agile methodologies.
- Managed multiple projects simultaneously, maintaining strict deadlines and high-quality standards.
- Maintained comprehensive documentation of development work to facilitate knowledge sharing among team members.
- Enhanced software functionality by identifying and resolving complex technical issues.
- Built and deployed software while maintaining a focus on scalability and maintainability.
- Utilized MongoDB for database management and Kafka for distributed messaging systems.
- Provided technical mentorship to the development team, fostering a collaborative and learning-driven environment

Software Architect, 12/2021 - 05/2022

Bitso SAPI De CV – Remote

- Led the architecture and development of scalable solutions using RabbitMQ and DynamoDB to support critical financial operations.
- Designed and architected highly performing solutions to meet business requirements, focusing on scalability and high availability.
- Played a key role in developing RESTful APIs for internal and external integrations, ensuring seamless communication between different software components.
- Managed a remote development team, providing technical guidance and fostering an innovative development culture.
- Analyzed technical debt and worked closely with the development team to resolve it, improving system performance and maintainability.
- Prepared comprehensive Software Architectural documents to enhance the visibility and understanding of both proposed and existing solutions.
- Conducted code reviews and refactoring sessions to ensure high-quality, scalable solutions.
- Collaborated with business analysts, engineering, and DevOps teams to deliver high availability solutions for mission-critical applications.
- Built and deployed software using Java (SpringBoot and Micronaut), as well as PHP (Vanilla and Laravel) to create efficient, scalable systems.
- Provided architectural guidance during complex development efforts, aiding the team in coding complex logic and delivering high-performance solutions.

Lead Software Engineer, 04/2021 - 12/2021

Interswitch Limited

- Served as the lead architect for mission-critical financial systems, including Visa Direct and Swift GPI integrations, ensuring secure and efficient transaction processing.
- Designed and developed RESTful Web APIs using Java Spring Boot to support seamless communication and real-time processing across distributed systems.
- Implemented RabbitMQ to ensure reliable messaging and communication between different system components, supporting high availability.

- Led a team of developers through the architectural design and implementation process, ensuring solutions aligned with business requirements and project goals.
- Architected and implemented core transfer service integrations to 3rd-party platforms, enhancing functionality and service capabilities.
- Designed and built the Visa Direct integration service to process interbank FX-denominated transactions through the Visa Card network.
- Designed and built the Swift GPI integration service, which processed interbank FX-denominated transactions through the Swift Alliance network.
- Developed highly performing solutions by evaluating project requirements and designing systems that surpassed client expectations.
- Built and deployed software using Java (SpringBoot and Vertx), ensuring the systems' scalability, performance, and reliability.

Lead Software Engineer, 04/2019 - 04/2021

Wema Bank Plc

- Led a team of 11 software engineers and business analysts, overseeing recruitment, performance appraisals, and mentoring to foster team growth and cohesion.
- Rebuilt the bank's Card Management System, Core Banking Application API, and Online Account Opening systems, enhancing system efficiency and scalability.
- Designed and implemented improvements to the NIP (Interbank transfer) system, reducing failure rates and turnaround time (TAT) with modern software architecture.
- Built and deployed software using C# (ASP.Net Core, .Net Core) and JavaScript (React, Angular), ensuring scalable, reliable solutions.
- Created a new Transaction Alert service, improving delivery efficiency by over 200%.
- Updated legacy codebases to modern standards, reducing error rates by 70%.
- Managed team resources based on skill levels and project requirements, ensuring successful project delivery.
- Mentored junior developers and engineers, enhancing their skills in solution planning and improving overall team performance.

Lead Software Engineer, 04/2009 - 03/2019

Skye Bank Plc Now Polaris Bank Limited

- Managed a team of 3 developers, overseeing recruitment, performance management, and providing technical guidance.
- Led the migration and modernization of legacy banking systems, improving system reliability and reducing error rates by 70%.
- Built, tested, and deployed scalable, highly available, and modular software products using C# (ASP.Net Core, .Net Core) and Java (SpringBoot).
- Analyzed requirements and designed, developed, and implemented software applications to support multiple business solutions.
- Coordinated with project management staff on database development timelines and project scope.
- Collaborated across all stages of the software development lifecycle, from requirements gathering to production releases.
- Oversaw over 10 major enhancements to existing software systems, ensuring improved performance and functionality.
- Developed code fixes and enhancements for inclusion in future releases and patches.

Education:

B.Sc., Physics, 2007

University of Ibadan, Nigeria
